

Mobile Watch

Affordable quad-core smartphones, announcements from BlackBerry as well as some eye-candy from Nokia and more...

Security Watch

A roundup on the risks and preventive actions from around the globe that are relevant to safety and online security.

Globular Clusters

A lot has happened in the logosphere since we last met, from interesting partnerships and acquisitions, to new products and services being revealed by some of the biggest names in the business.

Croma and Groupon Partnership

Croma and Groupon have announced a partnership that will certainly warm the hearts of those who are always on the lookout for gadgets deals. The partnership commences with the launch of a special micro-site, gadgets.groupon.co.in which will feature deals on smartphones, tablets, laptops and cameras. Croma is a leading electronic retailer in the country, from the house of Tatas. Groupon is a leading player in the daily deals business.

On day one, we did notice some interesting schemes. One of them is the Apple iPad 2 (64GB – Wi-Fi) available for ₹26,500, and this version usually retails for around ₹30,000 in stores. Another is the Toshiba Canvio portable hard drive, 1TB with USB 3.0, retailing for ₹4,499. This drive, in most stores, retails for ₹5,500. Over time, we expect the variety of products to become wider and the deals to become even better, and will hopefully be calculated on market prices and not the MRP.

Outlook.com gets Skype

Skype has been gracing Windows 8 Pro and RT for some

time, including the Windows Phone 8 OS, and finally, last month, it is expanding its reach to web services. Skype just got released as a web-plugin for Outlook.com integration, but only in the U.K.

Skype for Outlook.com is currently only available in the U.K., with U.S and Germany getting the feature over the coming weeks. Globally, the feature is set to be available by



“summer,” which could be as late as August. Skype for Outlook.com requires a one-time download of a plugin, which is available for the most recent versions of Internet Explorer, Chrome and Firefox. Users can connect to Outlook.com using their Microsoft account. People who already have existing Skype accounts can link it to Outlook.com, which will allow them to add their Skype contacts to the email service. The process seems a little complex, but once the corresponding accounts are all linked together, using the features is suppos-



edly seamless. Let's hope that this solution is all that it's hyped up to be.

YouTube subscription announced

Google has officially launched its much talked about paid video subscriptions service for YouTube. Google says it's currently a “pilot program” with subscription plans starting at 99 cents a month. The paid channels are currently being offered with 14-day free trial and could be available at discounted price if user chooses to subscribe for a year at a time.

YouTube's paid video subscriptions service currently features 53 channels, featuring content from HDNet, UFC and the PGA Digital Golf Academy. Some of the subscriptions are priced as high as \$9.99 a month. Once you have bought a subscription to a paid channel, you'll be able to check out videos on any device.

LinkedIn now at over 20m users in India

LinkedIn's subscriber base in India has gone past 20 million. The company says it has grown by 500 percent since it kicked off India operations in November 2009. The pro-

fessional networking service had hit 10 million users in the country in June 2011.

India's 20 million subscribers account for about 9 percent of LinkedIn's global subscriber base at 225+ million. The U.S. continues to be top market for LinkedIn with a subscriber base of over 74 million.

“The growth of our member base and clients in India over the last few years is a testament to the value we are adding to our members' lives every single day. And that is the result of the disruptive power of the LinkedIn platform and the passion of our people,” says Nishant Rao, LinkedIn India's Country Manager.

Yahoo's Tumblr Acquisition, Flickr Revamp, Twitter Partnership

Yahoo has been undergoing some nice changes lately under the leadership of Marissa Mayer. From revamping Flickr to introducing a new weather app for iOS, the company has been doing a good job with breathing new life into existing services, and today, they have announced a new partnership that should extend the endeavour. Yahoo and Twitter have announced

